TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain a Delay to a Customer

Explain | PPF | Customer Call

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Explain to a customer why an order is late, where it is now and when it will come, then answer their concern.

WHO You work for a small office-furniture company in Johor Bahru. A new tuition centre in Taman Molek ordered 20 grey chairs from you.

SITUATION You promised them for Monday. On Monday morning you checked them: 8 were black, not grey, because the factory made a mistake. So you sent those 8 back. It is Tuesday, and the owner has just called to ask where her chairs are.

NEED She needs to know why her chairs are late, where they are now and when they will come. 12 grey chairs are ready in Senai; 8 new ones reach you on Thursday; all 20 are delivered on Friday, 9–11 a.m. You can bring the 12 tomorrow.

GOAL Say sorry, explain what happened, where the chairs are now and when they will come, check the plan is okay for her, and answer her concern.

What happened

- Promised: Monday · 20 grey chairs
- Monday morning: 8 were black, not grey
- Why: the factory made a mistake · the 8 went back

Now and next

- Now: 12 ready in Senai · factory making 8 new ones
- Thursday: the 8 reach us · we check every chair
- Friday, 9–11 a.m.: all 20 delivered · can bring the 12 tomorrow

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: “The tuition centre called. Their 20 chairs didn’t come yesterday. Please call the owner back. What will you tell her?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Kumar’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

I’m really sorry your chairs didn’t come yesterday. We checked them, and 8 of the 20 were black, not grey, because the factory made a mistake. So we sent them back. Right now, the other 12 are ready in our warehouse in Senai, and the factory is making 8 new grey ones. The new ones will reach us on Thursday, and we'll check every chair. After that, we’re going to deliver all 20 to you on Friday, between 9 and 11 a.m. Is that okay for you? We want to help while you wait. For example, if you need chairs before Friday, I can bring the 12 grey ones tomorrow.

P PAST · WHAT HAPPENED AND WHY

P PRESENT · WHERE IT IS NOW

F FUTURE · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT, AND WHEN

! CHECK · WHAT I CAN DO NOW

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Mei Ling tells a customer why his refund is late. Past → Present → Future → Check.

- [ ] I'm sorry your RM350 refund didn't come last week. The bank sent it back because one digit in the account number was wrong.
- [ ] Is that okay? I'll also send you a photo of the bank slip today, so you can check it.
- [ ] I'm going to send it again this afternoon, and it will reach your account by Thursday.
- [ ] So right now, the money is back in our account, and I have your correct account number from your email.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · what happened and why · **P** = Present · where it is now · **F** = Future · what happens next, and when · **!** = Check · what I can do now

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SORRY AND WHAT HAPPENED

- [ ] I'm sorry your … didn't come on …
- [ ] We promised it for …, but …
- [ ] It's late because …
- [ ] When we checked it, …

WHERE IT IS NOW

- [ ] So right now, …
- [ ] At the moment, it's in …
- [ ] The factory is making …
- [ ] … are ready in our warehouse.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT, AND WHEN

- [ ] It will reach us on …
- [ ] We're going to deliver it on …
- [ ] It will be with you by …
- [ ] If you need it sooner, I can …

CHECK

- [ ] Is that okay for you?
- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] So that's … at …, okay?

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] I understand. In that case, I can …
- [ ] I'm sorry about that. I'll check …
- [ ] I know you're worried. This time, we'll …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. The chairs are late. [so / then / because] The factory made 8 of them in the wrong colour.

2. Eight chairs came in black, not grey. [For example, / because / so] We sent them back to the factory.

3. We want to help while you wait. [After that, / For example, / because] I can bring the 12 grey chairs tomorrow.

4. The new chairs will reach our warehouse on Thursday. [because / For example, / After that,] We'll deliver all 20 to you on Friday.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Yesterday morning we _____ the chairs before delivery. (What happened, with a time)
   ○ checked ○ was check ○ checking
2. Twelve chairs _____ ready in our warehouse. (Where things are now)
   ○ be ○ is ○ are
3. Right now, the factory _____ eight new grey chairs. (What is happening now)
   ○ is making ○ making ○ is make
4. We _____ deliver all 20 chairs on Friday morning. (The next step, a plan)
   ○ are go to ○ going to ○ are going to

SLIDE 09 Past → now → next, with a day

Say what happened with a past verb, where it is now with is / are or is …ing, and what happens next with will or going to. Give each part a day or a time.

Yesterday we **checked** the chairs, and 8 **were** black.

Right now, 12 chairs **are** ready, and the factory **is making** 8 more.

They **will reach** us **on Thursday**.

We**'re going to deliver** them **on Friday, between 9 and 11**.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · WHAT HAPPENED AND WHY

I'm sorry your … didn't come on … It's late because …

P

PRESENT · WHERE IT IS NOW

So right now, … is / are …

F

FUTURE · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT, AND WHEN

It will reach us on … We're going to deliver it on …, between … and …

!

CHECK · WHAT I CAN DO NOW

Is that okay for you? For example, if you need …, I can …

SLIDE 11

Customer Call

The speaker explains a late order from a mixed-up card. The customer cannot see it: they write the note, then say one need (A or B), and the speaker answers it.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number. Customer: read the Start line. Speaker: sorry → what happened → now → next.
2. Speaker: check ('Is that okay for you?') and stop. Customer: read back the day and time, then say need A or B.
3. Speaker: acknowledge, then answer. Round 2 (2:00): customers move one seat. Same card, shorter. Customer: A or B.
4. Round 3 (2:00), frames closed: speakers close the workbook and keep only the card. Then swap roles, new card.

Card 1 · Menus for a new restaurant

Card 2 · Laptops for an accounting firm

Card 3 · Hari Raya hampers for a car showroom

Card 4 · A water filter at a condo

Customer's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
What happened			
Where it is now			
New day and time			
Answer to my need			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Amy asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. My first class is on Thursday evening, and I have 10 students. I can't wait until Friday.
2. Friday morning is difficult. I'm only at the centre after 2 p.m.
3. How do I know the new chairs will be grey this time?

Start with: **I understand. In that case, I can … · I'm sorry about that. I'll check with … and tell you by … · I know you're worried. This time, we'll …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

You bake cakes at home and sell them to friends and neighbours. A neighbour ordered a chocolate cake for her son's party on Saturday. She planned to collect it at 11 a.m. This morning your oven broke. The repairman comes on Friday, so you will bake on Friday night, and the cake will be ready at 1 p.m. on Saturday. Send her a voice message: what happened, where things are now, what happens next. Then check that 1 p.m. is okay.

I'm sorry, the cake will be late. This morning, my oven … · Right now, I'm waiting for … · I'm going to … It will be ready at … · Is 1 p.m. okay for you?

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says sorry, what happened and one reason for the delay.
- [ ] Says where the order is now and what happens next, with a day and a time.
- [ ] Checks the new plan with the customer, then answers the customer's need or says when the customer will hear back.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

What happened and why	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Where it is now and when it comes	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Checking and answering the need	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Menus for a new restaurant

You own a new restaurant in Mount Austin. Start: 'Hi, where are my menus?' Fill the note. Then ONE need. A: you open on Thursday night and need at least 100 menus. B: you are there only after 3 p.m.

Card 2 · Laptops for an accounting firm

You run an accounting firm in Tebrau. Start: 'Hello, where are our laptops?' Fill the note. Then ONE need. A: two new staff start tomorrow; each needs a laptop. B: your office is closed on Friday.

Card 3 · Hari Raya hampers for a car showroom

You work at a car showroom in Skudai. Start: 'Hi, our hampers didn't come!' Fill the note. Then ONE need. A: you need 25 hampers for an open house tomorrow. B: you need all 50 by Wednesday, 11 a.m.

Card 4 · A water filter at a condo

You live in a condo in Bukit Indah. Start: 'Nobody came to fit my water filter!' Fill the note. Then ONE need. A: on weekdays you are home only after 7 p.m. B: you are free only on Saturday or Sunday.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Menus for a new restaurant

Can do: send the 120 menus today with our driver · Promised: Tuesday · Next: the other 80 on Friday, 10 a.m. · Why: the special paper ran out; new paper came this morning · Now (Wednesday): printing, 120 of 200 done

Card 2 · Laptops for an accounting firm

Now (Tuesday): the new laptops are on a lorry from KL · Can do: lend 3 old laptops today · Why: the supplier sent the wrong model · Promised: Monday · Next: Ali sets them up on Thursday; delivery Friday, 9 a.m. · Order: 10 laptops

Card 3 · Hari Raya hampers for a car showroom

The other 20: Wednesday, 2 p.m. · A flood at the biscuit factory; the biscuits came late · Promised for last Friday · We can bring the 30 ready ones today by 5 p.m. · Today is Monday: packing, 30 of 50 done

Card 4 · A water filter at a condo

The technician was on medical leave (MC) · A new technician can come on Wednesday, 10 a.m. · Promised for Saturday, 10 a.m. · Evening visits: 7.30–9 p.m., any weekday · Today is Monday: the filter is ready in our shop